

PHILOSOPHY

Courses

Below you will find a list of our current or recent offerings. See the [course catalog](#) for descriptions and updated information.

18-104 Selected Introductory Topics

Topics chosen introduce students to philosophical questions and methods in relation to historical or contemporary issues and often from an interdisciplinary perspective. May be repeated with change in topic. (H)

18-114 What Is Philosophy?

An introduction to conceptions and practices of philosophy as modes of thinking, investigating, and writing about the world and ourselves, as well as the ways in which such conceptions and practices are situated within their historical and geopolitical contexts. (H)

18-124 Critical Thinking

An introduction to the nature and structure of logical argumentation. Students will learn to analyze, construct, and evaluate arguments, as well as to identify common forms of fallacious thinking. These skills will be applied to the analysis of philosophical, moral, and political reasoning, among others, to improve reading and writing competences and to become more rigorous thinkers overall. Contributes to Legal Studies Certificate. (H)

18-144 Philosophy of Love & Sex

This course explores diverse perspectives on sex and love, including ethical, religious, political, and cultural issues surrounding them. Emphasis will be placed on contemporary understandings and beliefs, as well as practices of intimacy in the U.S. and globally. The goal of the course is to encourage philosophical reflection on topics related to sex and love. Key themes, such as gender, race/ethnicity, sexual orientation, class, nation, and ability, will be

Race and Ethnicity Studies/Allied Course. (H)

18-164 Self, Ethics, Society

An introduction to philosophical investigations of the character, development, and care for the self, with an emphasis on the question of the self's relationships to others: ethical responsibilities, social structures, and the relation between the two. Contributes to Legal Studies Certificate and Spanish for Healthcare Professions Certificate. (H)

18-194 Introduction to Feminist Philosophies

An historically informed introduction to key texts in feminist theory. Our approach to the issues and debates will be interdisciplinary and readings will be drawn from a range of disciplines such as philosophy, anthropology, sociology, psychoanalysis, and cultural studies. Contributes to Feminist Studies and Race and Ethnicity Studies/Allied Course. (H) (SJ) (PJ)

18-214 Politics and Economics

A critical exploration of the development and implications of the peculiarly modern understanding of politics and the economy as distinct and autonomous spheres, tracing some of the key historical stages in articulating (and troubling) this distinction and exploring various Marxist, Polanyian, feminist and other critiques of it, as well as the alternatives they propose. Contributes to Economics, International Studies, and Legal Studies Certificate. (H)

18-234 Environmental Philosophy

An examination of some of the philosophical, ethical, and political questions posed for contemporary society by climate change and the ecological crisis. Particular focus will be given to interrogating the idea of Nature, as something outside of, opposed to, pre-existing human beings, and possible alternatives to it, as well as to questions of how we might think/live/do politics in an era where many effects of long-term climate change are now clearly unavoidable. Contributes to Environmental Studies. (H)

18-244 Native American Philosophies

A selective survey of philosophical thought developed by the original inhabitants of territories variously known as Abya Yala, Turtle Island, Anáhuac, or in modern colonial terms, the Americas. We will consider the philosophies and practices of these groups against the

Contributes to International Studies, Latin American and Border Studies, and Race and Ethnicity Studies/Group-Theme Course. (H)

18-254 Philosophy, Race & Revolution

This course is oriented by the Haitian Revolution, the only successful slave revolution in history, which exposed the contradictions of Western philosophy's developing notions of race and its new universalist vision of human rights. Beginning with that revolution, the course follows the development of this contradiction - and efforts to redress it - through abolition, across waves of civil rights and anticolonial struggles across the 20th century, and into the present day. Contributes to International Studies, Latin American and Border Studies and Race and Ethnicity Studies/Allied Course. (H)

18-284 Latin American Philosophy

An introduction to modern and contemporary Latin American philosophy (incl. Hispanic-American) and its European and indigenous roots. Key issues to be considered are colonialism and decolonial practices, knowledge production, nationality, race, ethnicity and gender. Readings to be drawn from authors such as Bolívar, Martí, Vasconcelos, Alcoff, Mariátegui, Anzald a, Rivera Cusicanqui, Quijano, Mignolo, Freire, among others. Contributes to International Studies and Race and Ethnicity Studies/Allied Course. (H) (SJ) (PJ)

18-314 Marxisms

An introduction and examination of key concepts and debates in the development of Marxist theory, from Marx to the present day. Particular emphasis will be given to conceptions of class and class struggle, including how class relates to issues of gender and race; questions of political organization ('the party,' social movements, etc.); and conceptions of alternatives to capitalism. Contributes to International Studies. (H)

18-324 The Embodied Self

An exploration of the emergence of this modern concept, the self, in its psychological, autobiographical, phenomenological, anthropological, political and epistemological contours, as well as the way in which accounts of the self have reckoned with its grounding in the body.

18-554 19th/20th Century Philosophy

A selective survey of key thinkers, texts, and traditions across the 19th and 20th centuries.

Possible topics range from Hegel to standpoint epistemology; existentialism to psychoanalysis; phenomenology to poststructuralism. This course will combine careful reading and analysis of texts, concepts, and arguments with efforts to situate them within an increasingly global world of ethical, political and social relations: revolutionary upsurges and the rise of mass democracy, industrialization and de-industrialization, feminist waves, fossil fuel and financial economies, the heights of imperialism and antiracist, anticolonial and decolonial struggles. (H)

18-354 Critical Philosophy of Race

A selective survey of contemporary critical philosophical approaches to race, with emphasis on intersections with gender, class, nationalism and imperialism. This course focuses on the ways race has been constructed as a category of identity across various cultures, academic disciplines and historical periods, and on the relationship between race and ethnicity as categories of difference. Contributes to Feminist Studies, International Studies, and Race and Ethnicity Studies/Concepts Course. (H)

18-374 Feminist Ethics

This course traces the history and development of feminist ethics while considering its central issues and overall project. Areas of concentration may include discussions of human rights and social justice, transnational perspectives in ethical theories or biomedical ethics, and what it means to live a feminist life. Contributes to Feminist Studies. (H)

18-614 Ethos, Identities, Differences

This course will focus on historical understandings of the interactions between individuals and society, especially on the ways in which a society's ethos, its overarching set of ideals, values and beliefs, relates to the ideals, values and beliefs of individuals within that society. It will examine the ways in which both individual identities and social identities are formed, the extent to which a society constructs individual identity, and vice versa. Further, the course will examine the ways in which differences emerge both within individuals and in society and the

18-624 Being, Structure, Change

This course focuses upon the conceptual categories through which human beings negotiate their experience of themselves and the world and examines how those categories are formed and gain or lose currency. In every age and currently, ideas about order and structure; what kinds of things there are and how they relate; how things work, be, or become the things they are; and how we are to understand both the processes of change and the background within which change occurs, such as space and time itself, shape both how we see ourselves and the world and how we act in it. Prerequisite: One course in Philosophy. (H) (CRITICAL HISTORIES).

18-634 Experience, Language, Knowledge

Humans are knowers: we generate truths and beliefs about the world and our place in it that guide our behavior and our work, as well as our cultural and political forms. This course asks questions such as: How is knowledge possible? What counts as knowledge? What are the limits of human knowledge? This kind of inquiry analyses the way knowledge is determined by mental, perceptual, emotional and social phenomena, particularly experience and language, and whether this determination is informed by historical processes. Prerequisite: One course in Philosophy. (H) (CRITICAL HISTORIES).

18-644 Peoples, Power, Organization

This course focuses on historical understandings and productions of collective social and political identities and agents, the manners (political, economic, cultural, etc.) in which such collectives relate to one another, and the various ways in which such relations have been and could be organized. How might understandings different forms of power and organization assist us in redressing various forms of oppression, domination, exploitation; in furthering various forms of empowerment, equality, justice, liberation? What is the relationship between philosophy and social transformation? Prerequisite: One course in Philosophy. Contributes to Legal Studies Certificate. (H) (CRITICAL HISTORIES)

18-914 Colloquium in Philosophy

Required of majors in Philosophy, normally in their final year. Offered every fall. Prerequisite: Philosophy 18-604. (H) (WA)

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